

30 > Windows 11 Power User Checklist

7. Set Windows Security basics on (real-time protection, etc.).
8. Turned off noisy “suggestions” where possible in Start/settings.
9. Know the difference: Device encryption vs BitLocker (Home vs Pro).
10. Tested one recovery option (you know how to reach Recovery settings).

B) Start menu + taskbar control (11–18)

11. Pinned only your real daily apps in Start.
12. Unpinned defaults you never use.
13. Added useful folders to Start (Downloads/Documents etc.).
14. Reduced “Recommended” noise using Start toggles (as available).
15. Cleaned taskbar: removed icons you don’t click weekly.
16. Surfaced the system tray icons you actually need (VPN/BT/cloud).
17. Pin-to-taskbar discipline: only “always-on” apps stay pinned.
18. Use Start Search as default (Win, type, Enter) more than browsing.

C) Virtual desktops (19–26)

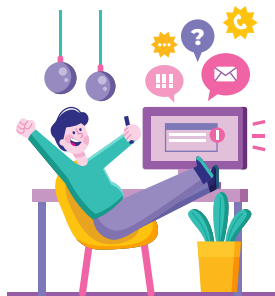
19. Use Task View (Win+Tab) comfortably.
20. Created at least 3 desktops for roles (Work/Study/Personal).
21. Renamed desktops to real names.
22. Set different wallpapers per desktop for instant recognition.
23. Switch desktops via keyboard (Win+Ctrl+←/→).
24. Moved a window between desktops via Task View drag/drop.
25. Chose taskbar + Alt-Tab behavior across desktops (current vs all).
26. Have a “Meetings desktop” that stays presentation-safe.

D) Snap mastery (27–34)

27. Invoke Snap Layouts with Win+Z.
28. Use the maximize-hover Snap flyout.
29. Snap with keyboard arrows (Win+←/→) without thinking.
30. Use Snap Assist to fill remaining zones quickly.
31. Built one repeatable “study” layout (PDF + notes + browser).
32. Built one repeatable “work” layout (mail + docs + spreadsheet).
33. Built one repeatable “dev” layout (IDE + terminal + docs).
34. Know where Multitasking settings live for snap/desktops tweaks.

E) PowerToys upgrades (35–40)

35. Installed PowerToys the official way.
36. Enabled FancyZones and created at least one custom layout.



37. Have a 60/40 “main + reference” layout for a laptop screen.
38. Have a layout per monitor (if you use an external display).
39. Tried at least one more PowerToys utility (Run / PowerRename / Peek).
40. You can explain why FancyZones beats manual resizing for you.

F) Developer + power tools (41–46)

41. Installed WSL (or know the one-command route: `wsl --install`).
42. Listed distros / checked WSL version (`wsl -l -v`).
43. Used Windows Sandbox once to test something unknown safely.
44. Know when to use Sandbox vs a full VM (Hyper-V).
45. Opened Reliability Monitor or Event Viewer at least once when troubleshooting.
46. You can identify “what changed” using history/timeline tools (updates, crashes).

G) Backup, automation, resilience (47–50)

47. Enabled File History to an external drive or network location.
48. Or set up Windows Backup to OneDrive for key folders (Desktop/Documents etc.).
49. Created one Task Scheduler automation (daily/weekly/logon).
50. You have a “panic plan”: where your backups are + how you’d restore.

What level are you now?

- 0–15: Tourist — you know features exist, but your workflow hasn’t changed.
- 16–30: Capable — you’ve cleaned up Windows and can multitask without chaos.
- 31–40: Power user — virtual desktops + snapping are default behavior; you’re faster daily.
- 41–50: Operator — you automate, back up, test safely, and troubleshoot with evidence.

What to explore next

- If you scored low on 19–34: double down on Virtual Desktops + Snap until it’s muscle memory.
- If you scored low on 35–40: spend one evening building two FancyZones layouts—laptop and external monitor.
- If you scored low on 41–46: install WSL, then try one dev workflow (Git, Python/Node, basic CLI tooling).
- If you scored low on 47–50: stop negotiating — set up File History or Windows Backup, then add one weekly automation.
- If you’re already 41+: your next frontier is repeatability — turn your best routines into “one-click” flows (Task Scheduler + shortcuts, or deeper Power Automate later).

Tick your score, pick your weakest block, and upgrade one habit this week. Windows 11 rewards consistency more than genius. **d**